

Anti-Inflammatory Recipes: Easy UK Meals for Joint Health

Eating for your joints does not have to be complicated. These simple, affordable recipes use UK-available ingredients to fight inflammation naturally.

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What you eat has a direct impact on inflammation levels in your body. The Mediterranean diet — rich in omega-3 fats, antioxidants, and fibre — has the strongest evidence for reducing arthritis symptoms.

Here are five simple, affordable recipes using ingredients available in any UK supermarket.

1. Turmeric & Ginger Salmon Tray Bake (Serves 2)

****Prep:**** 10 mins | ****Cook:**** 20 mins



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****Ingredients:**** - 2 salmon fillets - 1 sweet potato, cubed - 1 red pepper, sliced - 1 courgette, sliced - 2 tbsp olive oil - 1 tsp ground turmeric - 1 tsp fresh ginger, grated - 1 clove garlic, crushed - Juice of half a lemon - Salt and pepper

****Method:**** 1. Preheat oven to 200°C/180°C fan 2. Toss vegetables in 1 tbsp olive oil, turmeric, ginger, and garlic. Spread on a baking tray 3. Place salmon fillets on top, drizzle with

remaining olive oil and lemon juice 4. Bake for 18–20 minutes until salmon flakes easily

****Why it helps:**** Salmon provides omega-3 fatty acids (EPA and DHA), turmeric contains curcumin, and ginger provides gingerols — all potent anti-inflammatory compounds.

2. Berry & Beet Recovery Smoothie (Serves 1)



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****Prep:**** 5 mins

****Ingredients:**** - 1 small cooked beetroot (vacuum-packed is fine) - 100g frozen mixed berries
- 1 banana - 1-inch piece fresh ginger - 200ml oat milk - 1 tbsp ground flaxseed

****Method:**** Blend everything until smooth. Add more milk if needed.

****Why it helps:**** Beetroot contains betalains that reduce inflammation markers. Berries are rich in anthocyanins. Flaxseed adds plant-based omega-3 (ALA).

3. Warming Lentil & Spinach Dhal (Serves 4)

****Prep:**** 10 mins | ****Cook:**** 30 mins

****Ingredients:**** - 200g red lentils, rinsed - 1 onion, diced - 2 cloves garlic, crushed - 1 tsp turmeric - 1 tsp cumin - 1 tsp garam masala - 400ml coconut milk - 400ml vegetable stock - 200g fresh spinach - 1 tbsp olive oil

****Method:**** 1. Sauté onion and garlic in olive oil for 3–4 minutes 2. Add spices and cook for 1 minute 3. Add lentils, coconut milk, and stock. Simmer for 25 minutes 4. Stir in spinach until wilted. Season to taste

****Why it helps:**** Lentils provide plant protein and fibre. Turmeric and cumin are anti-inflammatory. Spinach is rich in vitamin K, which supports bone health.

4. Mackerel & Avocado Toast (Serves 1)

****Prep:**** 5 mins

****Ingredients:**** - 1 tin smoked mackerel fillets - 1 slice sourdough or wholegrain bread, toasted - Half an avocado - Cherry tomatoes, halved - Lemon juice - Black pepper

****Method:**** Mash avocado onto toast. Flake mackerel on top. Add tomatoes, a squeeze of lemon, and black pepper.

****Why it helps:**** Mackerel is one of the richest sources of omega-3 in the UK. Avocado provides vitamin E and healthy monounsaturated fats.

5. Golden Turmeric Porridge (Serves 1)

****Prep:**** 2 mins | ****Cook:**** 5 mins

****Ingredients:**** - 50g porridge oats - 250ml oat or semi-skimmed milk - 1 tsp turmeric - Half tsp cinnamon - 1 tsp honey - Handful of walnuts and blueberries

****Method:**** Cook oats with milk, turmeric, and cinnamon. Top with honey, walnuts, and blueberries.

****Why it helps:**** Oats provide beta-glucan fibre that reduces inflammatory markers. Walnuts are the only nut rich in ALA omega-3. Cinnamon has antioxidant properties.

Key Takeaway

You don't need exotic superfoods — everyday UK ingredients like salmon, lentils, berries, and oats are powerful anti-inflammatory allies when eaten consistently.

Q&A

Question: What is the key thing to know about anti-inflammatory recipes: easy uk meals for joint health?

Short answer: Anti-inflammatory recipes for joint health use ingredients that help reduce inflammation in the body. The Mediterranean diet, rich in omega-3 fats, antioxidants, and fibre, has strong evidence for reducing arthritis symptoms. Examples include salmon, turmeric, ginger, beetroot, berries, lentils, mackerel, and oats, which provide compounds like omega-3 fatty acids, curcumin, betalains, and fibre.

Question: When should I seek professional advice?

Short answer: If symptoms persist or worsen, pain is severe and unresponsive to usual relief, or you develop new symptoms, contact your GP, physiotherapist or rheumatology team promptly.

Question: Where can I get free arthritis support in the UK?

Short answer: Versus Arthritis: 0800 5200 520. NRAS: 0800 298 7650. Free tools and guides at livingwitharthritis.org.uk.

General information only — not medical advice. Consult your GP or specialist before changing medication or starting a new programme. Emergency: 999. NHS advice: 111. Living With Arthritis UK · livingwitharthritis.org.uk